



The Helper

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*En Root (縁 'en' meaning
connection/destiny + root)*

a new communi-tea for elderly folks.

initial research

"5 Reasons why Seniors Resist Moving to a Senior Living Community but Really Should"

RESEARCH HIGHLIGHTS

Social isolation, loneliness in older people pose health risks

April 23, 2019

pain points:

they feel they are not "old enough."

prefer to stay in their own home because it is **comfortable** and **familiar**.

finding senior friendly communities are **too expensive** (ex. retirement homes)

"Loneliness acts as a fertilizer for other diseases," Dr. Cole said. "The biology of loneliness can accelerate the buildup of plaque in arteries, help cancer cells grow and spread, and promote inflammation in the brain leading to Alzheimer's disease. Loneliness promotes several different types of wear and tear on the body."

problem space

Elders who feel **socially isolated** need accessible spaces and opportunities that foster genuine community connections but **struggle to find purpose within their local area.**

Kenzie



The Silent Epidemic: How Loneliness is Affecting Our Senior Citizens

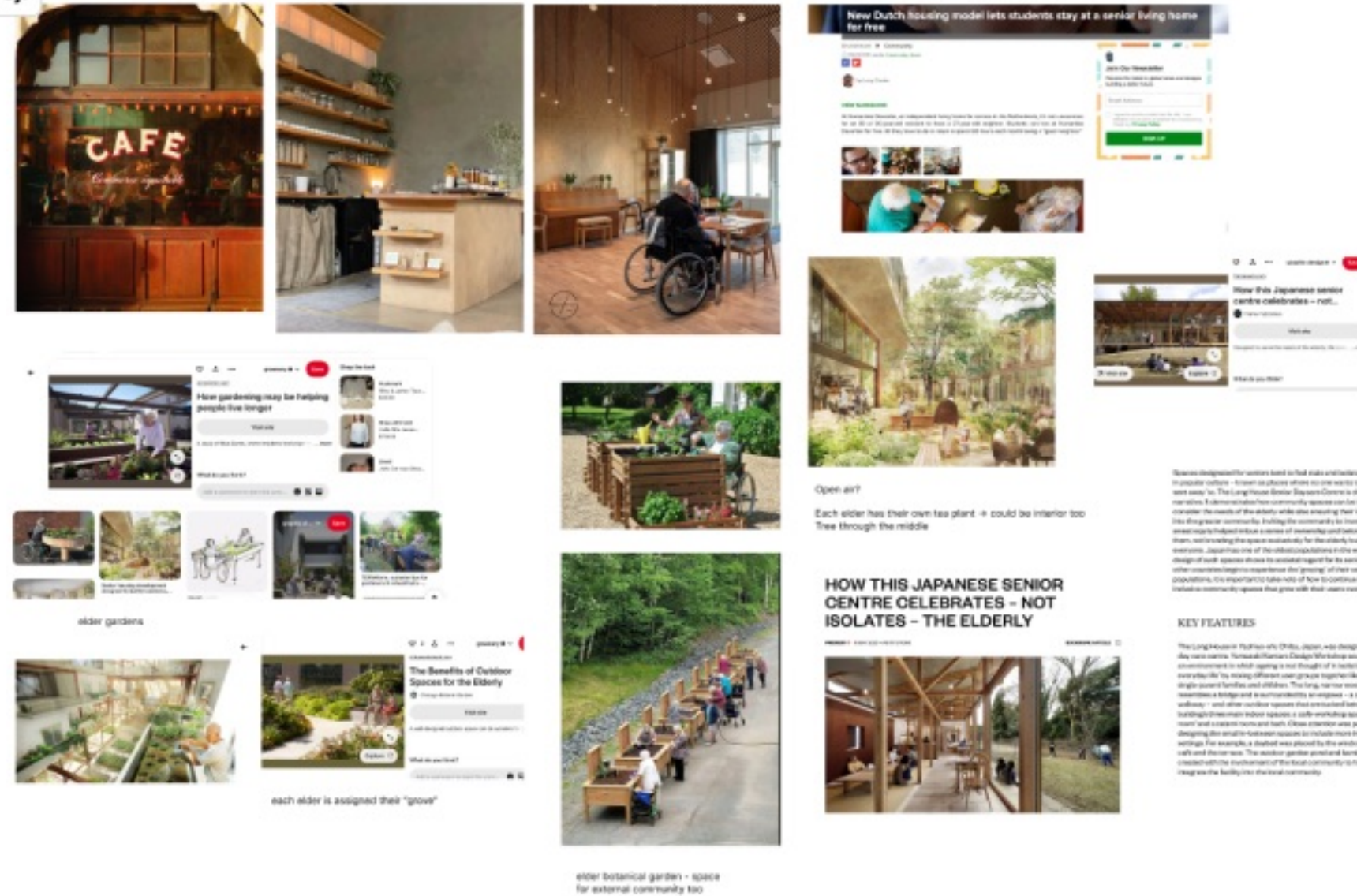
/ English Blog / By Eugenia Murray-McGinnis

Loneliness is a universal human experience, characterized by a feeling of social disconnection and isolation. It is not felt by any particular age group, but among senior citizens. They become a client epidemic that deserves our attention. As individuals age, they often face various challenges that can contribute to feelings of loneliness, such as the loss of loved ones, retirement, and declining physical health. Addressing this issue is a priority in Florida, where there are so many retirees, because loneliness can have severe consequences on the mental and physical well-being of senior citizens.

Loneliness is a silent epidemic, prevalent among senior citizens. Loneliness, often caused by social isolation, has negative impacts on senior citizens' health and mental health. Community programs, technology, and family/caregiver support can help combat loneliness among senior citizens.



Yeji



pain points:

they feel they are not "old enough."

prefer to stay in their own home because it is **comfortable** and **familiar**

finances

either it is isolation or a full service overnight living situation. how can we create something in between?

ideas:

transportation service to get taken to and from your home to a social space nearby at your own will/leisure.

implement important facilitators: young adult AND senior workers, people who are just in the space naturally to create a natural and friendly ambiance.

goal: to allow you to choose to be there for your own comfort and desires. (not because you are need to because you are "too old".



imagefx ai renders



- vertical elevator



- need to add hollow space beneath counter for wheelchairs
- include chairs that lay underneath that can be pulled out - something modular

- sleeping pods

accessibility



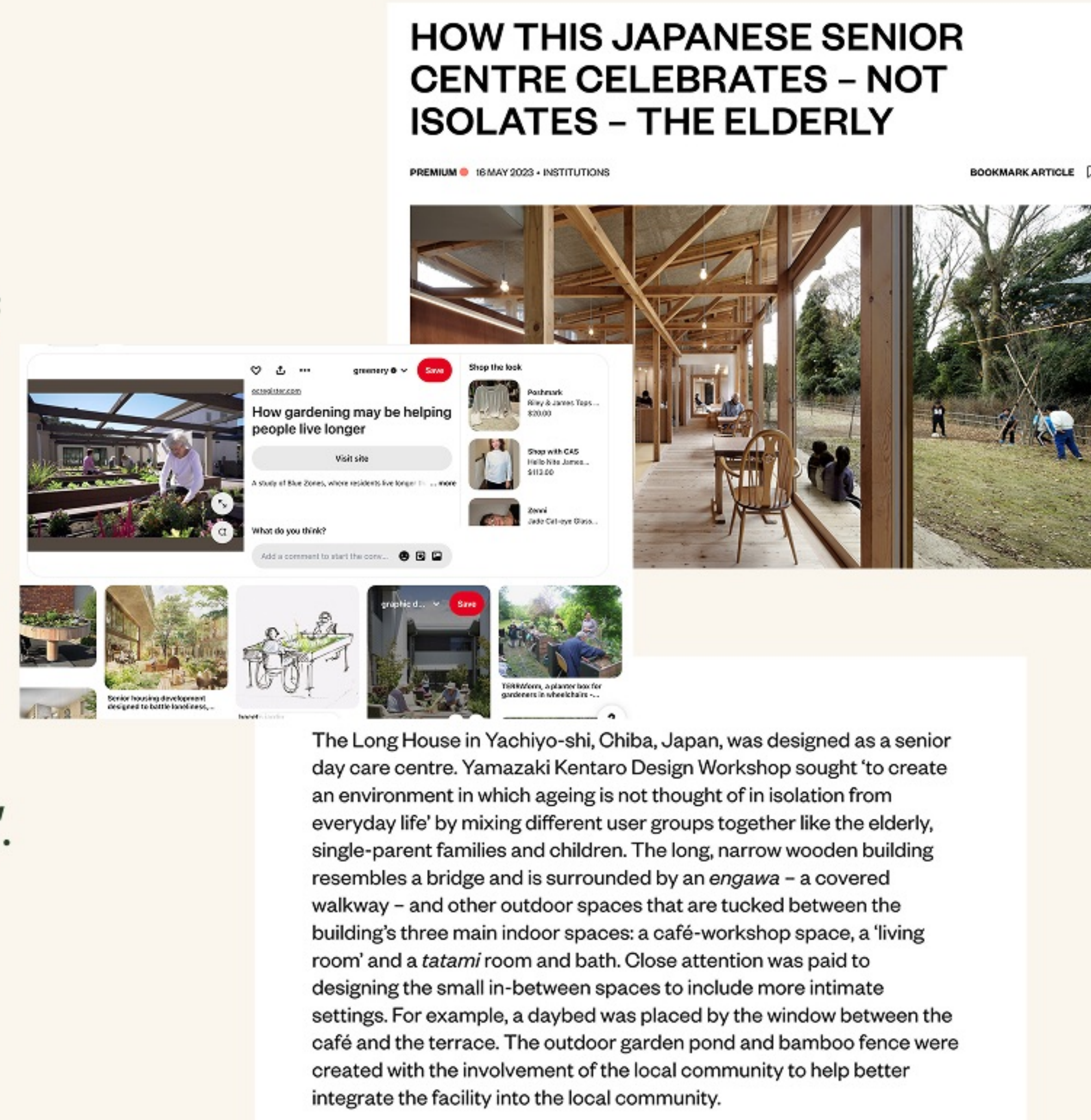
Things to think about

- warm lights + lots of lamps - orange, burgundy tones
- hints of greenery + plants
- wooden seating - japanese style?
- accessibility arrangements
 - non-slip floors, grab bars, wide doorways and hallways
- locations: walkable areas with established communities

moodboarding

solution research

- People engaged in **meaningful, productive activities** with others tend to live longer, boost their mood, and have a sense of purpose.
- Implement important facilitators: **young adult AND senior workers**, creating a natural and friendly ambiance.
- Allow you to choose to be there for your **own comfort** and desires. (not because you are need to because you are "too old").
- Social interactions can provide **psychological support** and reduce social isolation, loneliness, and depression.



physical space

- **Centralized courtyard** with all the tea plants
 - each elder decides what's in their grove
- **Elder botanical garden** - space for external community too
- **Earthy: wooden floors & structure**
- **Accessibility arrangements**
 - Non-slip floors, grab bars, open layout - wide doorways and hallways, wheelchair supports integrated in couches
- **Surrounding location:** walkable areas with established communities
- **Jars of tea:** diverse flavors, roasts, and profiles of tea to explore.



branding



01.

En Root Tea Cup

Teacups are typically small to allow for a more focused appreciation and mindfulness of the tea's flavor by taking smaller sips.



02.

Traditional Tea Sets

Connecting back to the traditional roots of tea ceremonies, the act of drinking tea has always been a gesture of respect, care, and connection.

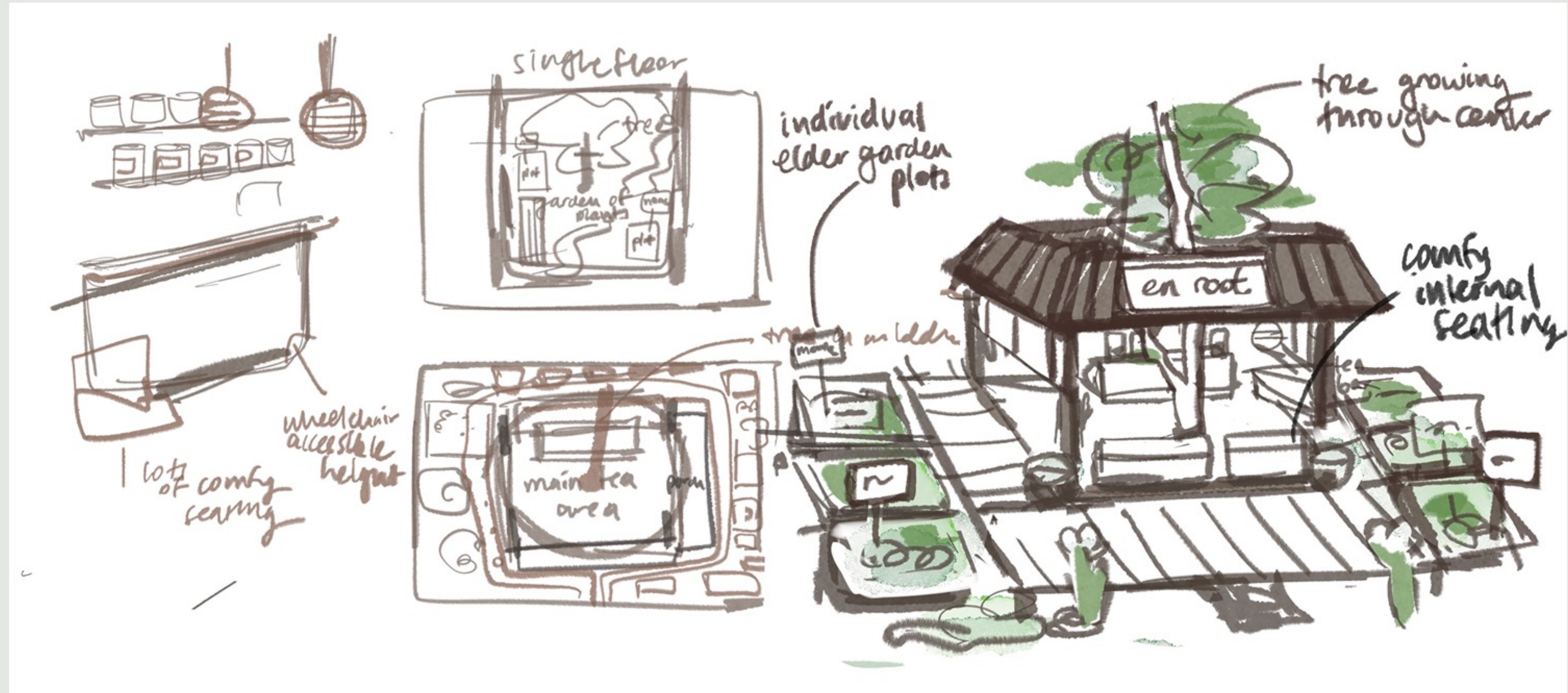


03.

CURVD® Ergonomic Coffee Mug

"ergonomic structure that distributes the weight of the beverage evenly, significantly reducing strain on joints and muscles. "

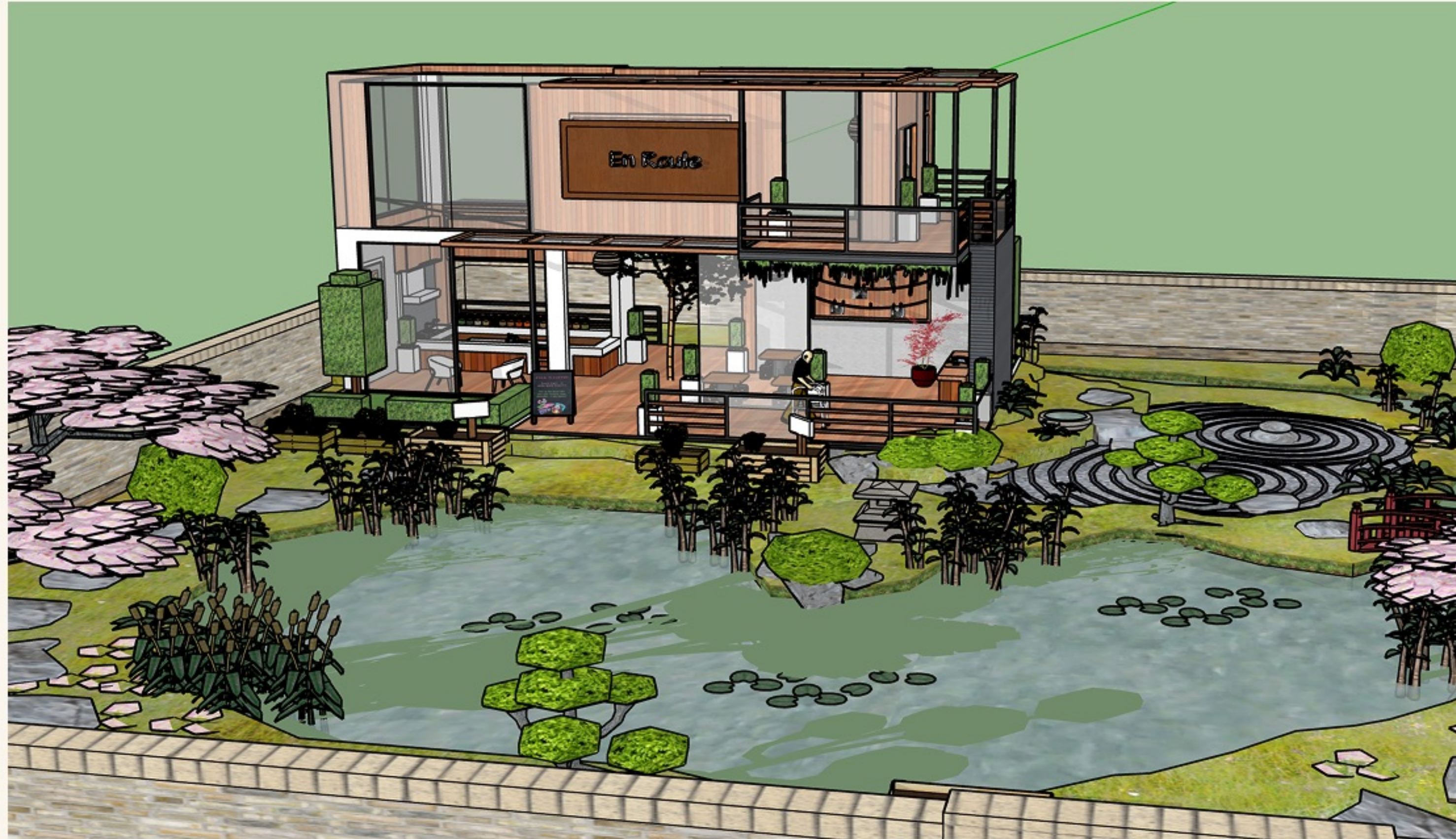
2-d sketch



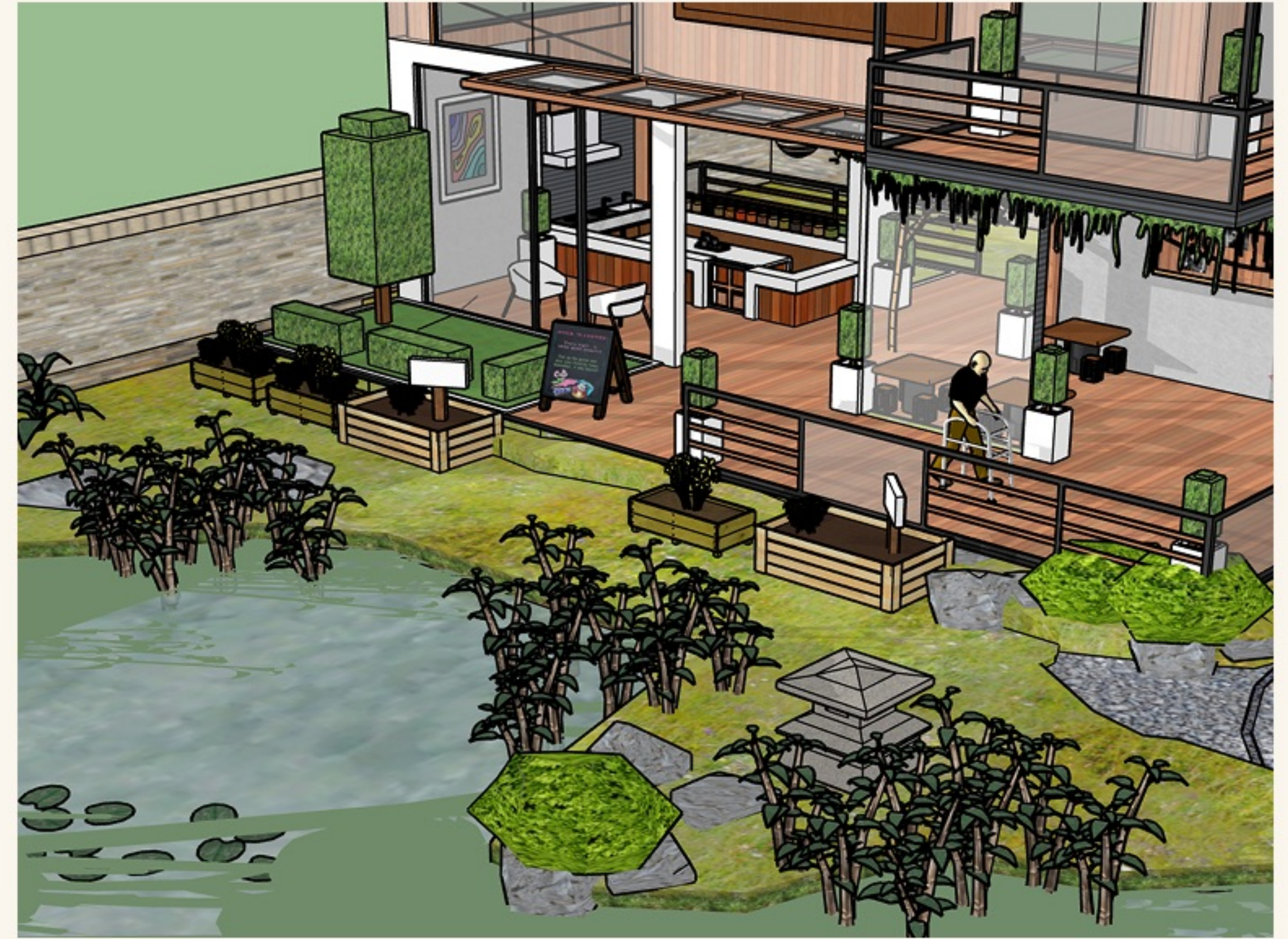
2-d sketch



3-d sketch up



3-d sketch up - garden



3-d sketch up - tea house



render



render



render



render



sources

- <https://www.nia.nih.gov/news/social-isolation-loneliness-older-people-pose-health-risks>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10671417/#B10-healthcare-11-02951>
- <https://www.nia.nih.gov/news/social-isolation-loneliness-older-people-pose-health-risks>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10671417/#:~:text=Social%20interactions%20can%20provide%20psychological,on%20life%20satisfaction%20%5B12%5D>
- <https://www.nia.nih.gov/news/social-isolation-loneliness-older-people-pose-health-risks>)